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MERCEDES GL350CDI
PRICE: RS 65 LAKH

USP The ultimate big daddy in off-roaders, the GL-class is for someone who is fascinated by size, ruggedness and the GL's go-anywhere capabilities.



6

MARUTI SUZUKI KIZASHI
PRICE: RS 10 LAKH (ESTIMATED)

USP A stunner and the most premium car Suzuki has ever made. With Maruti's packaging, it's great value for money too.



7

VW POLO & POLO NOTCHBACK
PRICE: RS 4 LAKH TO RS 8 LAKH

USP Stunning small car. It will be available with a tiny 1.2-litre common rail diesel engine. Watch out for the notchback, specially designed keeping in mind local requirements.



8

SKODA YETI
PRICE: RS 16 LAKH (ESTIMATED)

USP The go-anywhere car/SUV has great off-road prowess, thanks to the latest in electronics, drives like a car on the road but can tackle the worst of terrain as well.



9

TOYOTA ETIOS
PRICE: RS 4 LAKH (HATCHBACK)
TO RS 7 LAKH (SEDAN) (ESTIMATED)

USP Cars designed keeping in mind the Indian buyer but will also be exported worldwide. Exceptional Toyota quality is now affordable.



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TOYOTA PRIUS
PRICE: DEPENDS ON
DUTIES ON HYBRIDS

USP The bestselling hybrid car in the world will now be available in India. If you have a green heart or a guilty conscience, then this is the car to buy. Exceptional fuel efficiency and the ability to be plugged-in for charging.

car maker in the world, has made its intent very clear by setting up one of the largest greenfield plants in the country. Its Polo notchback sedan, which will be launched in 2010, will be a car made specially to cater to Indian needs and will be sold in most of the emerging markets around the world.

The success of Hyundai and, to a lesser extent, Maruti Suzuki, with models made in India and sold around the world like the i10, the Getz and the i20 as well as the A-star (actually two successive generations of the Alto), have made sure that more and more companies will design and make cars in India, especially small cars.

But at the other end of the spectrum, the premium automakers see the potential of the Indian market and are also bringing in a slew of new products. BMW, riding on its wide range of new cars as well as SUVs, has overtaken Mercedes to become the number one luxury car maker in the country. In a short span of three years, the market for premium vehicles has expanded

from less than 3,000 cars to over 10,000 cars in a year that was seen as a bad one for the industry as general.

While Indian cars have been at par with what is sold around the world for the last decade or so, commercial vehicles are now catching up with world standards. There is renewed focus on the Indian market and what turned the tide in India's favour was the short life of the downturn here. While most markets were plunging into ever-deepening crisis, India was stable, although growth was stunted and before anyone else could realise, cars were being sold in record numbers all over again. If one looks from the last Auto Expo to the present one, it would appear that business is being carried on as usual.

For the consumer, all this augurs really well. There will be over 50 car launches this year and about 200 in the next two years. When one is being spoilt for choice, one can't really complain.

Yogendra Pratap is the editor of Autobild India